

NIKHIL SAMPAT MANE

Director of Operations | Sports Tech & AI Platforms

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Director of Operations with 14+ years leading high-performance teams across cricket analytics, fantasy sports, and AI-powered video intelligence platforms. Proven track record scaling operations from zero to production at India's largest sports tech organisations. Deep cross-functional delivery expertise spanning Product, Engineering, and Data Science. Skilled in SLA management, AI/ML workflow automation, data annotation pipelines, and real-time platform operations.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Director of Operations & Growth | *Dream Play – Sports AI (Dream Sports)* Mar 2026 – June 2026

- Own end-to-end operations for an AI-powered padel & pickleball video analytics platform, managing 100+ daily video analytics sessions across 50+ partner courts. Strategy and growth wise taking court-live decisions and implementing revenue models for various partners.
- User funnels, targeting venues to acquire users & build roadmaps. Partner with marketing & run experiments to acquire users.
- Built a 0-to-15 member in-house data annotation team, establishing quality frameworks and HITL workflows to support Computer Vision / ML training pipelines.
- Initiated AI-first automation in Ops workflows, improving team throughput by ~30% & reducing manual intervention by 40%.
- Defined & tracked SLAs for video ingestion, & report delivery; maintained 98%+ on-time delivery across all partner accounts.

Director of Operations | *RushLine – Sports AI (Dream Sports)* Oct 2025 – Feb 2026

- Led live sports data workflows and real-time delivery across all RushLine platform verticals; maintained 100% SLA compliance across a 5-month tenure. Complete program ownership and multi-stakeholder governance.
- Led supply-side strategic decision-making to optimize resource allocation and platform liquidity for the cricket prediction ecosystem. Collaborated with Product & Engineering to streamline data pipelines, reducing average processing time by 20%.
- Collaborated with the marketing team to design and execute growth experiments, leveraging data-driven insights to boost user engagement.
- Partnered with the Data Science team as a Domain Expert, providing clean core datasets and deep cricket subject matter expertise to refine and improve prediction model accuracy.

Director, Operations | *Dream11 (Dream Sports)* Jan 2018 – Oct 2025

- Grew from Associate to Director in 7 years at India's #1 fantasy sports platform (250M+ users, IPL title sponsor).
- Owned match-day operations — player pricing, fantasy points validation, and post-round locks — across 15,000+ events/year covering cricket, football, kabaddi, and basketball.
- Streamlined operations by automating the winner declaration process, successfully reducing the SLA by 50% for high-traffic, critical matches.
- Optimized operational scalability and drove a 40% reduction in manual intervention by engineering AI-first automated workflows, significantly reducing the cost of operational business waste while driving a 2% to 3% increase in topline revenue.
- Led a 30+ member operations team; drove cross-functional delivery with Product, Tech, and Data Science on launch of new sports verticals and platform features.
- Mitigated business waste and minimized operational errors by 35% through the design and implementation of automated validation checks and a two-tier QA workflow across high-traffic, real-time operations.

Senior Associate – Content & Analytics | *Sportz Interactive* Jun 2012 – Dec 2017

- Delivered digital and social media strategy for Mumbai Indians, achieving highest IPL share of voice in 2017 with 4M+ cumulative impressions per campaign.
- Produced live cricket analytics and stats-based editorial content for 5+ broadcast and digital clients, covering 200+ matches annually.

CORE SKILLS

Operations: SLA Management, Real-time Platform Delivery, Data Annotation, HITL Workflows, Process Automation
Technical: SQL (intermediate), Python (basic), JIRA, Asana, Notion, Looker, Tableau, n8n, Zapier, GPT API integrations **Domain:** Sports Operations, Fantasy Sports Platforms, Cricket Analytics, AI/ML Pipeline Support, Video Intelligence
Leadership: Team Building & Mentoring, Cross-functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Management, OKR/KPI Tracking

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MBA – Data Science & Analytics | *DY Patil University (Pursuing Part Time)* 2013
BSc. Computer Science
Certifications: Google Data Analytics (2023) | GenAI for Executives – Google Cloud (2024) | Microsoft Office Specialist (2022)